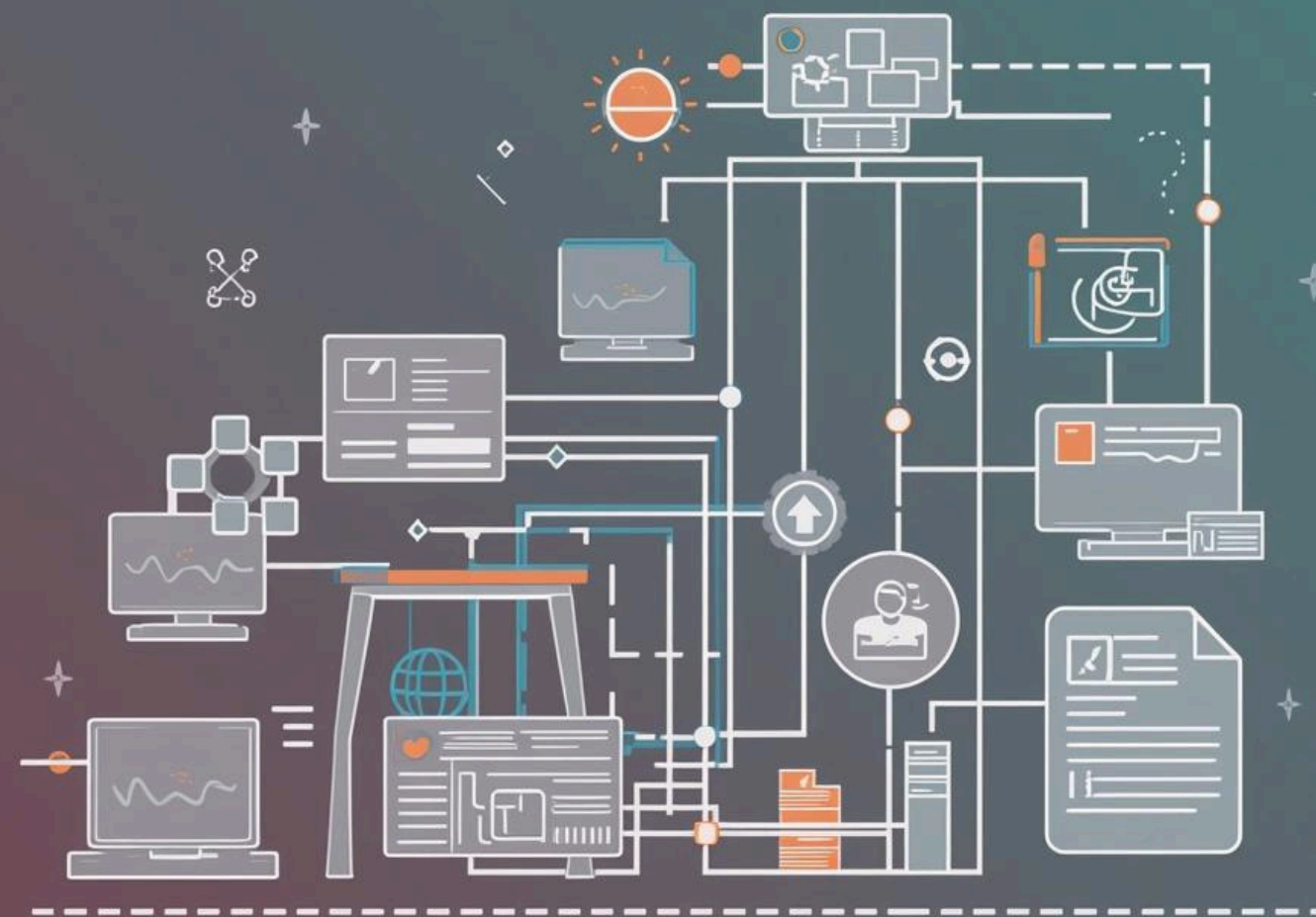




Canva

Canva Teams & Collaboration

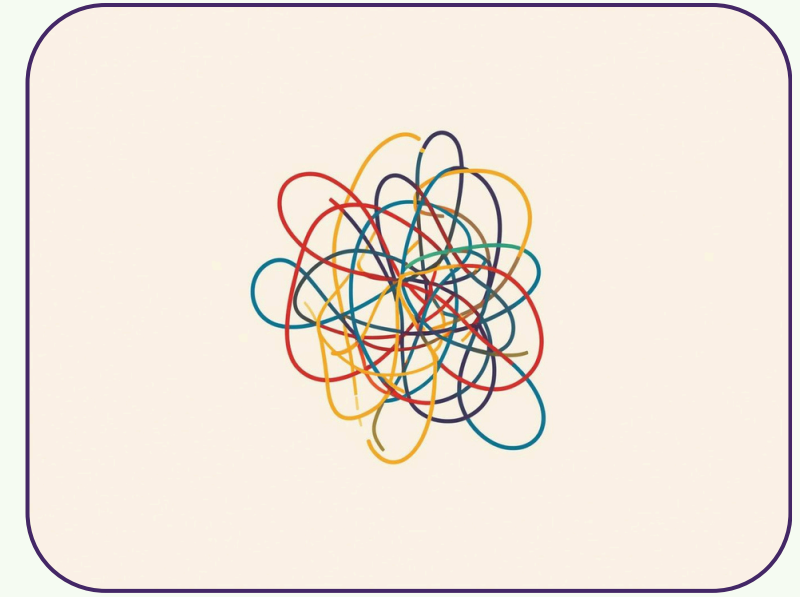
Resolving Friction via Governance

Anupam Sanidhya

Macro Problem

Exploring Governance Challenges in Design

Enterprises face significant collaboration friction due to misalignment and compliance issues, impacting efficiency and overall design outcomes.



Template Degradation

Users report that alignment and spacing become "garbled" when templates are shared, actively discouraging the use of collaborative features. Multi-person editing frequently destroys the structural integrity of locked brand templates.

Cost of Compliance

Enterprises allocate approximately **\$65K** per creative annually on manual reviews, a significant expense that highlights the inefficiencies present in their current workflows. Median approval cycles lag between 24 and 72 hours.

Asynchronous Handoff Friction

Users note that scheduling an asset locks it from peer editing, and sharing outside of rigid Team structures creates unnecessary operational hurdles.

1.) https://www.reddit.com/r/canva/comments/1dj8vc9/pain_points_for_canva/

2.) <https://aicamp.so/blog/ai-output-inconsistency-enterprise-solutions/>

3.) <https://webrand.com/blog/brand-compliance/enterprise-marketing-brand-consistency-challenges-solutions-guide>

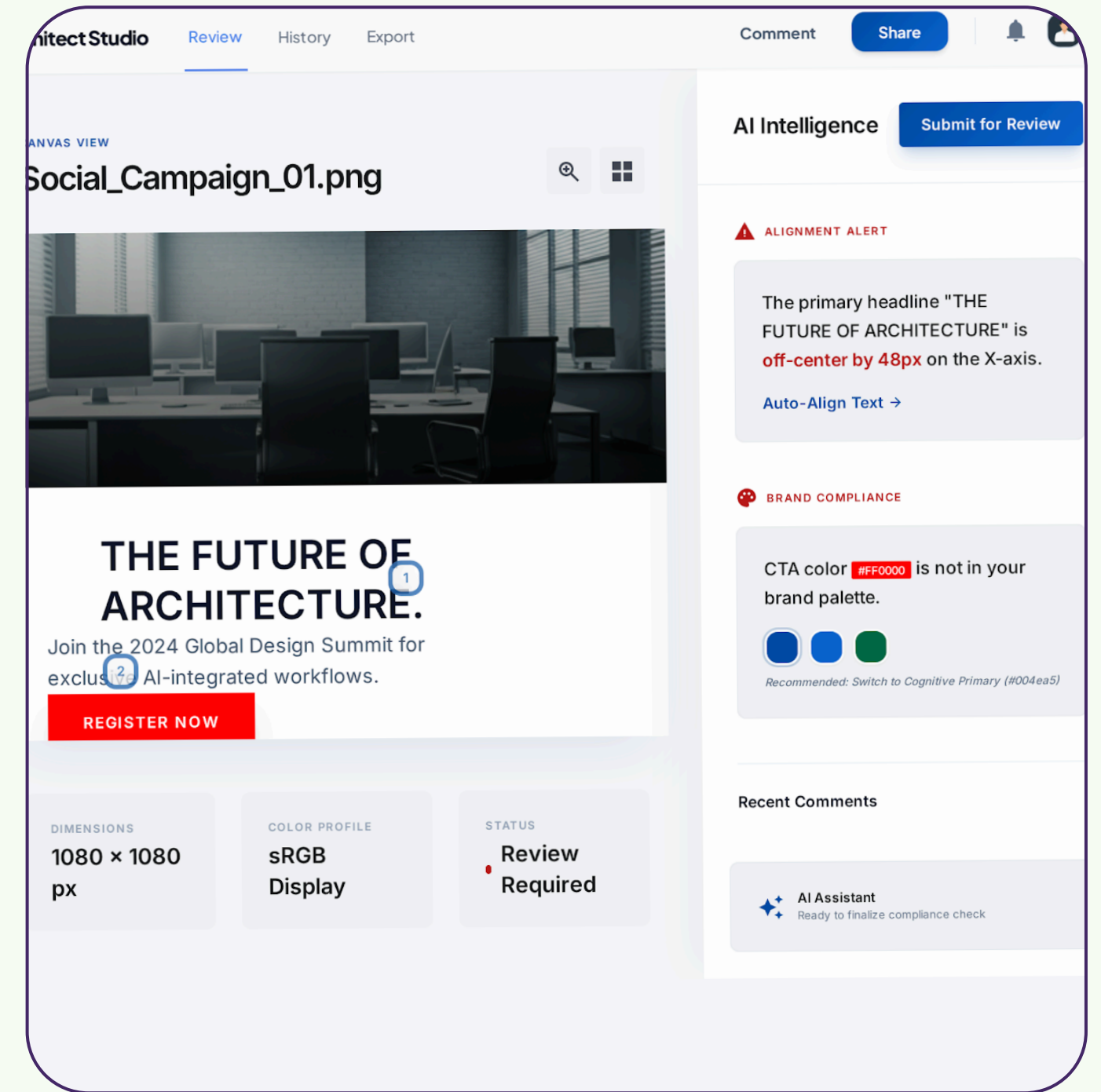
The AI-Native Solution

An autonomous AI teammate enhances brand compliance, streamlining collaboration and reducing friction within Canva's interface seamlessly. Organizations are no longer seeking novel generative capabilities; they are demanding measurable Return on Investment (ROI) through deep workflow automation, operational efficiency, and risk mitigation.

Link to the Prototype - [Canva AI Compliance Flow](#)

Overview of core functionalities

- **Autonomous Layout Remediation:** Instantly fixes broken layouts with smart detection and a simple snap-back action.
- **Pre-Flight Compliance Scoring:** Checks colors, text style and logo use, then gives a clear brand score.
- **Contextual Tone & Regulatory Auto-Correction:** Uses RAG & spots missing disclaimers or off-brand wording and offers ready-to-use fixes.



Success Metrics

Primary Operational Efficiency Metrics

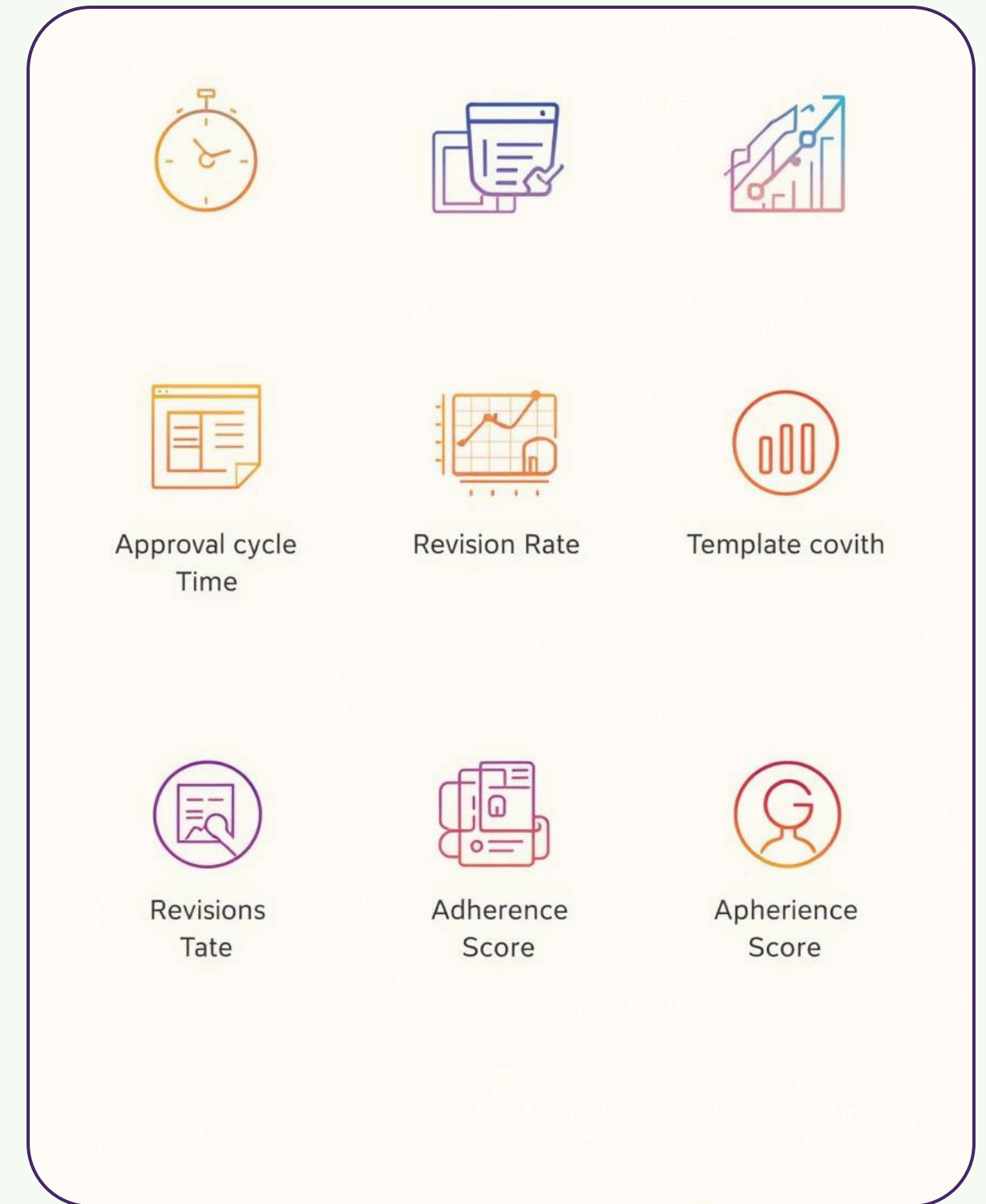
These metrics assess the Canva AI Agent's influence on previously identified workflow bottlenecks.

1. Approval Cycle Time (ACT): This measures the time from design submission to final approval. The goal is to reduce this time from 24-72 hours to under 8 hours by utilizing AI for compliance checks.
2. Revision Rate (RR): This metric tracks the average number of corrections needed before approval. A high RR suggests non-compliance with brand guidelines. Implementing AI aims to decrease human intervention and communication inefficiencies.
3. Template Adherence Score: This evaluates the compliance of final designs with brand templates. Success is indicated by increased adherence.

Secondary Product Health and Business Metrics

These metrics evaluate the AI model's effect on Canva's broader ecosystem.

1. AI Rejection Rate: This measures the frequency of users rejecting AI suggestions. A high score points to issues with AI accuracy and should remain below 5%.
2. Organization-Wide MAU: This tracks active users over a 30-day period. The aim is to enhance confidence and collaboration across



Shipping Plan

Phase 1: Alpha & Foundational Architecture (Weeks 1 - 6)

- Objective: Establish the rules engine and deploy auto-correction features.
- Teams Involved: Core Engineering, UX/UI Design, Data Analytics.
- Strategic Goals:
 - Develop computer vision models for spatial analysis and whitespace management.
 - Implement "Apply Smart Fixes" to fix "garbled template" issues, with hex code and typography validation.
 - Key Milestone: Internal testing with Canva's marketing team to establish latency metrics and ensure design integrity.

Phase 2: Beta & Agentic LLM Integration (Weeks 7 - 12)

- Objective: Introduce LLM components for semantic copy review.
- Teams Involved: AI Engineering, Legal & Compliance, Product Marketing.
- Strategic Goals:
 - Deploy a RAG architecture for secure document queries.
 - Integrate "Pre-Flight Compliance Score" in Canva's panel.
 - Key Milestone: Test with 50 Enterprise clients, aiming for a compliance flag rate below 10%.

Phase 3: General Availability & Enterprise Scaling (Weeks 13 - 16)

- Objective: Public launch with necessary admin tools.
- Teams Involved: Product Operations, Sales Enablement, Customer Success, Platform Security.
- Strategic Goals:
 - Launch an analytics dashboard.
 - Ensure compliance with SOC 2 and ISO 27001 standards.

Key Risks and Mitigation Strategies

AI Hallucinations Mitigation: Use a "Human-in-the-Loop" workflow, with deterministic logic for brand rules.

Data Privacy Mitigation: Ensure strict data isolation and privacy protections for customers.

Workflow Intrusiveness Mitigation: Implement background scanning, allowing creativity during drafting.

AI Workflow Appendix

Research & Data Synthesis

Leveraged LLMs (Gemini & Perplexity) to aggregate enterprise compliance data and unstructured feedback from Reddit and G2 and manually visited comments to verify.

- **The Meta-Prompt:** *"Act as a Senior UX Researcher at an enterprise SaaS company. Analyze recent Reddit threads, G2 reviews, and enterprise software analytics regarding Canva Teams. Identify the top three recurring operational bottlenecks users face when trying to maintain brand consistency across large, decentralized groups."*
- **The Strategic Discard:** AI initially suggested generic "more templates" insights. I rejected this; increasing volume exacerbates choice paralysis. Shifted focus to the specific technical bottleneck: *template garbling*.

Adversarial Pressure Testing

Utilized AI as a strategic opponent to stress-test the Agentic Governance solution against technical and regulatory constraints.

- **The Prompt:** *"I am proposing a new feature for Canva Enterprise: an AI agent that automatically corrects misaligned layouts and checks text against regulatory guidelines before a user can export a design. Acting as a CISO, what are the primary technical risks, regulatory risks, and UX friction points of this approach?"*
- **The Strategic Refinement:** AI identified the Authority Trap (over-reliance on automated checks). This insight shifted the architecture from full automation to a deterministic Human-in-the-Loop workflow for all regulatory copy.

Prototyping Log (Google Stitch)

- **Primary Prompt:** *"Act as an expert developer. Build a full-page Canva dashboard interface. The left sidebar should contain a basic navigation menu. The main central area should display a large, mock social campaign that appears slightly misaligned and has a button colour error. On the right side of the screen, build a persistent 'Collaboration & Review' panel. The overall aesthetic should be modern, clean, minimalist, and use a white, soft grey, and vibrant blue color palette reminiscent of enterprise design tools, mainly Canva. Use real placeholder text related to submitting a design for legal and brand compliance review."*
- Later, I added more prompts for my specific 4-screen creation.